GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

October 30th, 2026
Week 44
Volume 282, Issue 1259

Highlights:

- **Bids Improve**
- **Hormuz Tightens**
- **Freight Divides**
- **Supply Scarce**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"A wise man, therefore, proportions his belief to the evidence."

- David Hume

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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BUYERS RAISE THE STAKES

Last week's recovery in dry freight offered recycling buyers little encouragement. This week, however, sentiment has improved across the sub-continent, with recyclers showing greater willingness to compete for available tonnage. Bangladesh continues to lead the market, while Pakistan and India are also displaying renewed confidence. Despite improving buying interest, the shortage of suitable recycling candidates persists as owners continue to benefit from attractive trading alternatives.

The Strait of Hormuz supplied another reminder of the fragile security environment surrounding Gulf shipping. A tanker was attacked near Khasab, Oman, on October 29, reportedly sustaining an engine-room fire before resuming its voyage. The incident renewed concerns over passage security and insurance costs. For ageing tanker owners, disrupted trading patterns and restricted effective vessel availability continue to support employment opportunities rather than encourage recycling decisions.

Oil markets responded to the renewed uncertainty. Brent advanced above USD 117 per barrel on Friday, while WTI approached USD 104 as concerns over Middle Eastern supplies persisted. Elevated energy costs continue to pressure recycling operations and steel production, particularly across the sub-continent. Yet the same uncertainty can support tanker earnings, keeping older vessels commercially attractive for longer than recyclers would prefer.

Dry freight offered mixed signals. The Baltic Dry Index edged higher from 2,693 last Thursday to 2,712 on October 29, supported by Capesizes strengthening to 4,090. Panamaxes, however, weakened to 1,921, while Supramaxes eased to 1,870. The divergence suggests that pressure is emerging in selected vessel segments without producing a broader deterioration in earnings. For recycling buyers, the prospect of additional candidates remains encouraging, but there is still little evidence of a sustained increase in supply.

Steel markets provided no common direction. Indian plate recovered from an early-week decline to finish at INR 43,300 per ton, while Bangladesh remained steady at BDT 66,000. Pakistan moved in the opposite direction, falling from PKR 195,000 to PKR 188,000 per ton. Chinese steel also softened marginally to USD 307.47 per ton. Despite these uneven fundamentals, improving sentiment and persistent candidate scarcity continue to support buying interest.

Physical waterfront activity continued at Alang and Chattogram, with several previously secured vessels completing delivery, while Gadani reported no new movements. Bangladesh also received potentially important regulatory news, with the reported reclassification of ship recycling from the red to orange environmental category expected to simplify future yard approvals. The development has encouraged local sentiment, although implementation and environmental compliance considerations remain important.

Bangladesh retains the strongest conventional buying appetite, Pakistan is becoming increasingly constructive despite weaker steel, and India continues to benefit from specialist opportunities. Turkey remains selective within its established regional market. Across the sub-continent, buyers are showing greater confidence, but freight earnings and second-hand alternatives continue to favour owners. The willingness to buy is growing. The willingness to sell remains the missing ingredient.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 44 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

CHATTOGRAM FINDS FRESH MOMENTUM

Appetite Strengthens.

Chattogram enters the final days of October with improving recycling sentiment and renewed confidence among end buyers. Demand for suitable bulkers, tankers and container vessels remains healthy, supported by continuing yard requirements and expectations of improved domestic activity as the dry season approaches. Recyclers are showing stronger demolition ideas despite limited fresh vessel availability. Local steel remained unchanged throughout the week at BDT 66,000 per ton, approximately USD 538.56, providing stability without additional upward momentum. The anticipated seasonal recovery in construction and steel consumption remains an expectation rather than an established trend, while high energy costs continue to threaten downstream profitability. Nevertheless, the overall mood is noticeably more positive, with buyers increasingly willing to compete when workable candidates become available.

Deliveries Continue.

The waterfront remained active, with the 2,621 LDT cement carrier SHINAKI MARU delivered on October 29, followed by the 9,798 LDT bulker LONO and 8,275 LDT tanker GREEN on October 28. The 7,078 LDT bulker UNIORDER completed delivery on October 24, while the 9,759 LDT wood chip carrier CRIMSON SATURN arrived on October 28. These movements maintain activity across recycling yards and demonstrate the continued progression of previously secured tonnage. However, physical deliveries should not be confused with fresh market sales. Chattogram continues to process existing commitments while seeking a more consistent supply of recycling candidates.

Regulations Evolve.

A potentially important development emerged with the reported decision to reclassify ship recycling from the red to orange environmental category. The change is expected to simplify approval procedures for new yards and reduce regulatory delays, encouraging investment and expansion within the industry. However, its practical benefits will depend on implementation and the maintenance of credible environmental and worker-safety standards. With the dry season approaching, improved operating conditions could support yard productivity and domestic steel consumption, although energy-market instability remains a concern. Chattogram enters November with willing buyers, encouraging sentiment and expectations of seasonal improvement. The demand is becoming stronger. What remains uncertain is whether vessel supply will follow.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



ALANG BUILDS ON ITS STRENGTHS

Steel Strengthens.

Alang continues to benefit from its established position in specialist and non-ferrous-rich vessel recycling, with further deliveries reinforcing the diversity of its operating market. The 2,920 LDT reefer AFFINIS was delivered on October 29, followed by the 4,200 LDT general cargo vessel INZHENER VESHNYAKOV on October 27 and the 4,000 LDT INZHENER TRUBIN on October 24. These movements demonstrate the continuing importance of vessels whose composition, equipment and specialist handling requirements create opportunities beyond the conventional recycling market. Although fresh transactions remain limited, India's ability to attract a varied selection of candidates continues to provide an important commercial advantage.

Steel Recovers.

Domestic steel strengthened after an early-week decline, recovering from INR 42,300 per ton on October 24 to INR 43,300 by October 28, where it remained through Friday. The corresponding Dollar equivalent finished at approximately USD 456.17 per ton, unchanged against the previous Friday despite the recovery during the week. This has provided a more encouraging backdrop for recyclers without materially changing India's competitive position against Bangladesh and Pakistan for conventional tonnage. Financing costs, downstream steel demand and careful margin management continue to influence purchasing decisions. Recyclers remain particularly attentive to vessel specifications, where additional non-ferrous content or specialised equipment can justify stronger commercial interest.

Confidence Improves.

Overall sentiment has become more constructive, with buyers showing greater willingness to consider suitable opportunities. Nevertheless, Alang's established strengths remain concentrated in specialist vessels, compliance-sensitive candidates and units offering value beyond their basic steel content. India's September inflation reading of 5.54% also remains relevant to financing conditions and domestic demand. Conventional competition with neighbouring destinations remains challenging, but India's developed recycling infrastructure and specialist expertise continue to attract appropriate tonnage. The market is improving without abandoning the purchasing discipline that has supported its position. Alang is not attempting to compete for every available ship. It continues to focus on the vessels it is best equipped to recycle.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

GADANI REGAINS ITS APPETITE

Interest Returns.

Gadani enters November with improving sentiment and renewed interest in suitable recycling candidates. The measured approach that followed the exceptional purchasing activity earlier this year remains evident, but buyers are becoming increasingly constructive as they consider future yard requirements. Bangladesh continues to provide strong regional competition, although Pakistani recyclers remain capable of securing attractive tonnage when commercial conditions are appropriate. The principal difficulty remains the limited availability of fresh candidates, particularly while freight earnings and second-hand values continue to offer owners worthwhile alternatives. Buyers have not returned to August's urgency, but their willingness to compete is becoming more apparent.

Steel Retreats.

Domestic steel moved against the improving recycling sentiment, with local plate falling from PKR 195,000 per ton to PKR 188,000 on October 26, remaining unchanged thereafter. The corresponding Dollar equivalent declined from approximately USD 702.20 to USD 676.99 per ton. The correction places additional pressure on recycler margins, particularly where imported scrap remains an alternative source of raw material for steel production. September inflation eased to 10.26%, providing some macroeconomic relief, although cautious downstream steel demand and financing considerations continue to restrict purchasing flexibility. Improving demolition sentiment is encouraging, but stronger buying interest must ultimately be supported by recoverable steel values.

Supply Awaited.

No new vessel movements were reported at Gadani this week, following the steady progression of previously secured tonnage during recent months. Those earlier deliveries helped satisfy immediate yard requirements, allowing recyclers to approach new opportunities more selectively. However, maintaining an adequate pipeline remains important as the market moves towards the final months of the year. Pakistan retains established recycling infrastructure, competitive buyers and the ability to respond when suitable candidates become available. The renewed appetite is encouraging, although weaker steel calls for continued purchasing discipline. Gadani is becoming more interested in buying again. The next challenge is finding owners willing to meet that interest.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

ALIAGA HOLDS ITS COURSE

Aliaga experienced little material change during the reporting week, with recyclers maintaining a cautious approach towards fresh vessel acquisitions. Domestic finished-steel consumption remains subdued, while imported scrap conditions and processing expenses continue to influence purchasing decisions. Although the broader international recycling market has become more positive, Turkey's domestic fundamentals have provided limited encouragement for a meaningful increase in buying activity. Recyclers remain focused on commercially suitable opportunities rather than expanding purchases without adequate downstream support.

Market Selective.

The Turkish central bank's October 22 reduction in its policy rate from 37% to 36% has provided some relief to the financing environment. Nevertheless, borrowing costs remain elevated, while September inflation of 29.73% and continued Lira weakness complicate Dollar-denominated vessel purchases. Regional energy uncertainty presents an additional challenge through its influence on industrial operating costs. Any sustained recovery in recycling activity will therefore depend on improved steel consumption and greater confidence among domestic mills. For the moment, buyers have little incentive to depart from their selective approach.

Financing Conditions.

Aliaga continues to maintain its established position through geographical proximity to European and Mediterranean owners, specialist handling capabilities and relevant environmental compliance requirements. These advantages remain particularly important where vessel location, repositioning expenses and regulatory considerations influence recycling decisions. Despite limited fresh transactional activity, Turkey continues to serve a distinct segment of the international recycling market. The underlying position remains stable, with future improvement dependent on stronger domestic steel demand. Aliaga is maintaining its bearings while awaiting a more convincing recovery.

Regional Advantage.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly - Market Rankings

For Week 44 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	515 / LDT	535 / LDT	545 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Improving**	505 / LDT	525 / LDT	535 / LDT
3	India	**Improving**	470 / LDT	490 / LDT	500 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	290 / LDT	300-310 / LDT	320 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *An estimated **124.5 million barrels of oil** saved through ship recycling at Alang could fill a one-metre-diameter pipeline stretching approximately **25,200 km**, nearly two-thirds of the way around the Earth.*

- ***44.4 billion kWh of energy** saved through ship recycling at Alang could power **17.8 million medium-use British households** for an entire year.*

- ***276 million cubic yards of landfill space** saved through ship recycling at Alang could cover nearly **29,600 standard football pitches** to a depth of one metre.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
November 24 – Guru Nanak's Birthday	October 25 – November 01 November 07 – November 14

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 16 – Victory Day	November 07 – November 10 November 23 – November 26

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	01 January – New Year

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ALANG - Port Position as of October 30, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Affinis	2,920	Reefer	*Delivered October 29*
2	Inzhener Veshnyakov	4,200	General Cargo	*Delivered October 27*
3	Inzhener Trubin	4,000	General Cargo	*Delivered October 24*

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of October 30, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Shinaki Maru	2,621	Cement Carrier	*Delivered October 29*
2	Lono	9,798	Bulk Carrier	*Delivered October 28*
3	Crimson Saturn	9,759	Wood Chip Carrier	Arrived October 28
4	Green	8,275	Tanker	*Delivered October 28*
5	Uniorder	7,078	Bulk Carrier	*Delivered October 24*
6	B-LPG Sophia (D/VSL)	3,421	LPG Tanker	Arrived September 28

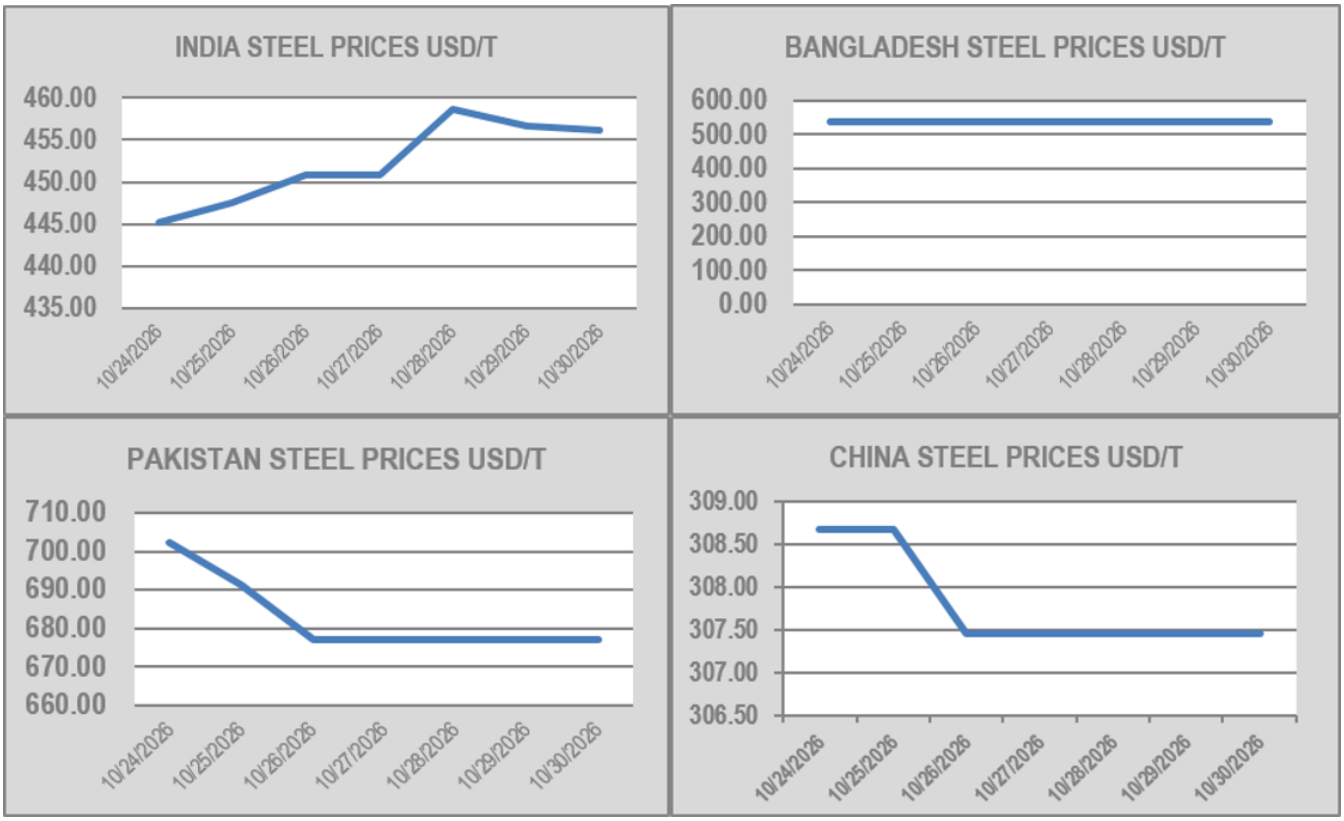
GADANI - Port Position as of October 30, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Sparrow	5,000	Bulk Carrier	Arrived October 21

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Steel Plate Prices

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
10/24/2026	445.17	42,300.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/25/2026	447.56	42,500.00	691.39	192,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/26/2026	450.91	42,800.00	676.99	188,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47
10/27/2026	450.91	42,800.00	676.99	188,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47
10/28/2026	458.59	43,300.00	676.99	188,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47
10/29/2026	456.65	43,300.00	676.99	188,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47
10/30/2026	456.17	43,300.00	676.99	188,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	307.47



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